

Scrum

A lightweight framework for generating value in complex problems through empiricism, collaboration, inspection and adaptation.

What is Scrum?

Scrum is a lightweight framework that helps people, teams and organizations generate value through adaptive solutions for complex problems. It is founded on empiricism and Lean Thinking, with transparency, inspection and adaptation as pillars. It is not merely a set of meetings.

Scrum Team and accountabilities

The Scrum Team consists of Product Owner, Scrum Master and Developers. Scrum defines no sub-teams or hierarchies. The Product Owner maximizes value and manages the Product Backlog effectively; Developers create a usable Increment; the Scrum Master is accountable for Scrum Team effectiveness and establishing Scrum.

Scrum Master is not the boss

The Scrum Master does not assign tasks or act as a line manager. They help the team and organization understand and apply Scrum, help remove impediments and improve team effectiveness. They are not the “QA lead” simply because QA professionals are on the team.

Sprint and Sprint Goal

The Sprint is the container event, one month or less. Work needed to achieve the Product Goal happens within Sprints. The Sprint Goal provides a single objective and flexibility around the exact work needed.

Sprint Planning

Planning starts the Sprint and covers why the Sprint is valuable, what can be done and how the selected work will be accomplished. QA can surface risks, testability, data, environments, integrations and acceptance criteria early.

Daily Scrum — the real purpose

The Daily Scrum is a 15-minute event for Developers. Its purpose is to inspect progress toward the Sprint Goal and adapt the Sprint Backlog, producing an actionable plan for the next day. It is not a status meeting for the Scrum Master or manager. The old three questions are optional, not required by the 2020 Scrum Guide.

Sprint Review

The Scrum Team and stakeholders inspect the Sprint outcome and determine future adaptations. It is more than a demo: it examines what changed in the product and environment and discusses next steps.

Sprint Retrospective

The Retrospective plans ways to increase quality and effectiveness. The team inspects people, interactions, processes, tools and the Definition of Done and turns learning into improvements.

Artifacts and commitments

Product Backlog has the Product Goal; Sprint Backlog has the Sprint Goal; Increment has the Definition of Done. These commitments reinforce transparency and inspection.

QA within Scrum

Scrum defines no separate QA accountability. QA professionals contributing to the Increment are part of the Developers in Scrum terms. Quality should be built throughout the Sprint, not handed to QA at the end.